

PLUG, SOCKET, AND SWORD BAYONETS

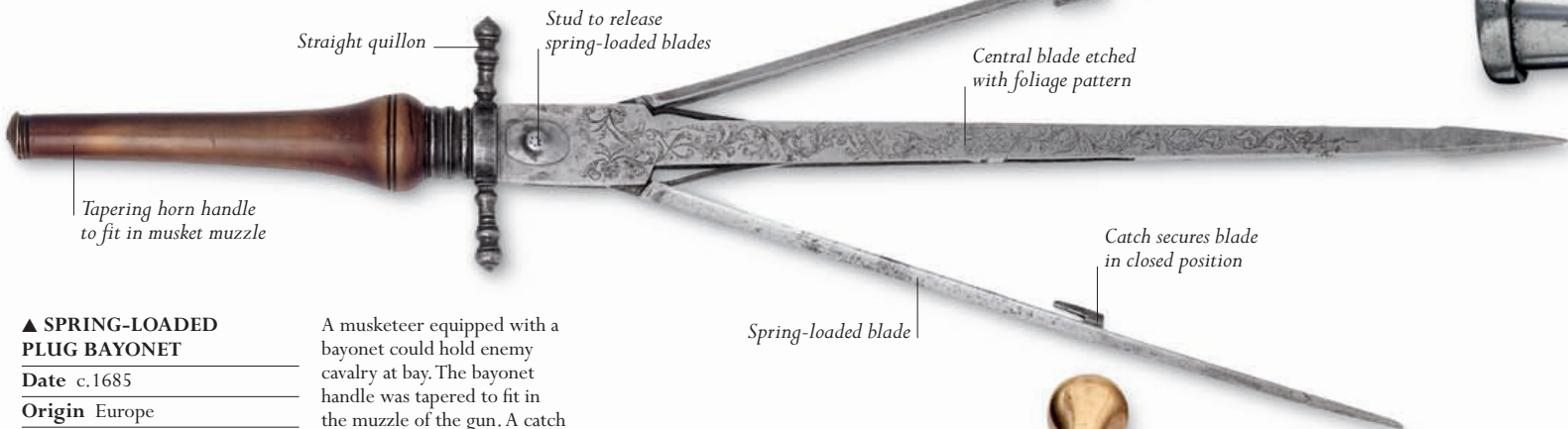
Infantrymen fighting with muskets were vulnerable to enemy attack while loading their weapons after firing, so originally fought alongside pikemen for protection. At the end of the 17th century, bayonets were developed to enable musketeers to defend themselves. The first type, plug bayonets, were daggers thrust into the musket's muzzle. They had to be removed to fire the weapon, and were superseded by socket bayonets, which were attached by a metal tube that engaged with a stud on the gun's barrel. In the early 19th century, many armies issued the longer sword bayonet, which could be removed from the gun and used in hand-to-hand combat.



▲ **ENGLISH OFFICER'S PLUG BAYONET**

Date	c.1680
Origin	England
Weight	600g (21oz)
Length	44cm (17¼in)

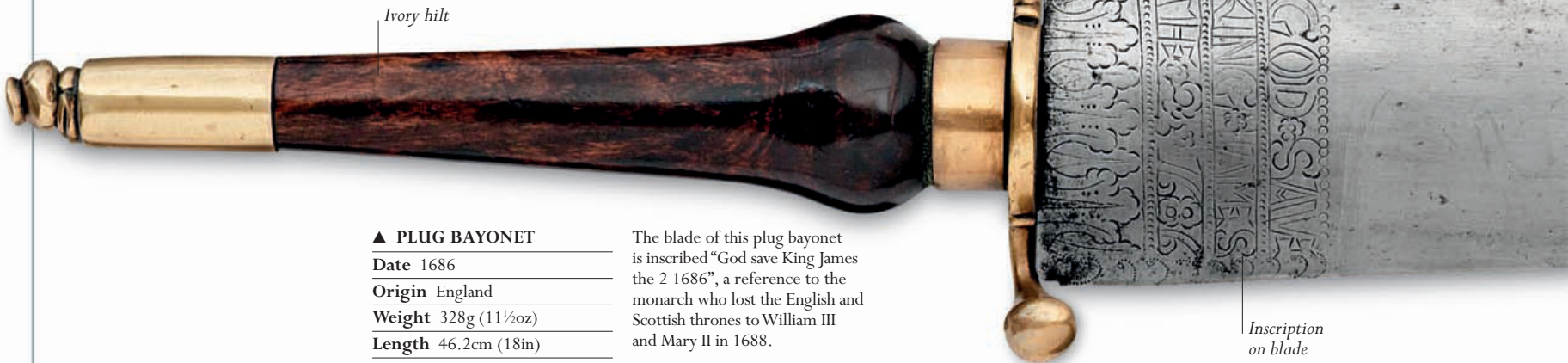
In addition to being weapons, bayonets could be removed from the gun and used for practical tasks. Officers' bayonets might also have ornate features, such as the cherubs on the handle of this blade.



▲ **SPRING-LOADED PLUG BAYONET**

Date	c.1685
Origin	Europe
Weight	370g (13oz)
Length	48.2cm (19in)

A musketeer equipped with a bayonet could hold enemy cavalry at bay. The bayonet handle was tapered to fit in the muzzle of the gun. A catch on the spring-loaded blades secured them in position.



▲ **PLUG BAYONET**

Date	1686
Origin	England
Weight	328g (11½oz)
Length	46.2cm (18in)

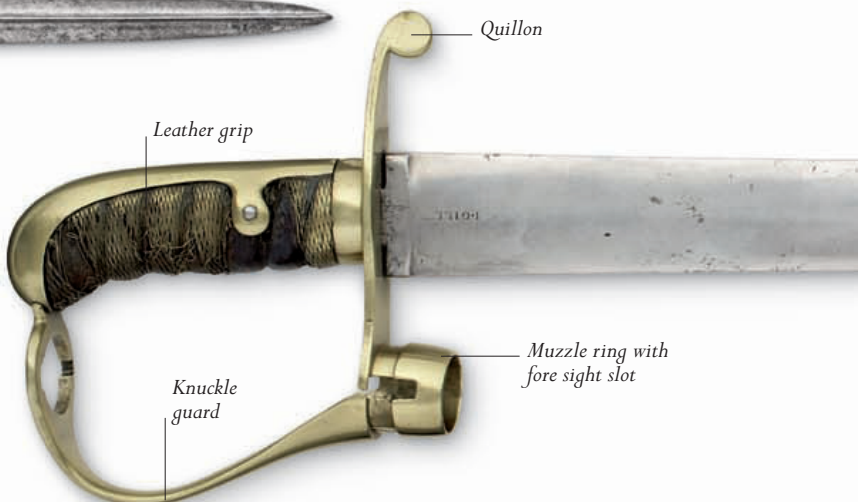
The blade of this plug bayonet is inscribed "God save King James the 2 1686", a reference to the monarch who lost the English and Scottish thrones to William III and Mary II in 1688.



▲ **OFFICERS' PLUG BAYONET**

Date	1695
Origin	England
Weight	700g (24¾oz)
Length	64cm (25in)

This type of bayonet had to be fitted into a gun barrel before use. English Royalist troops were defeated by charging Highlanders at the Battle of Killiecrankie, Scotland, in 1689, because they were too slow to mount their plug bayonets in the heat of battle.



Cherub decoration

Collar of socket

Central blade etched with foliage pattern

Catch secures blade in closed position

Spring-loaded blade

Inscription on blade

Tapering grip blocks muzzle when fitted

Centrally ribbed blade for rigidity

Leather grip

Quillon

Knuckle guard

Muzzle ring with fore sight slot